

BUY

Price \$16.20 (intraday 12-03-25)

FLASH NOTE

ADEPT-2 Continuation Has Grey Implications, But At Face is a Win for MPLT In Backdrop of Low Expectations

Summary

BMJ announced this morning that the ADEPT-2 study of Cobenfy in ADP will continue enrolling additional patients, after a review identified irregularities due to trial conduct at some sites. After this issue was identified, BMJ engaged with FDA, and an independent party conducted an interim analysis (BMJ notes they remain blinded) who recommended that ADEPT-2 should continue and enroll additional patients. Taking a step back here, ADEPT-2 has been an overhang for MPLT, as investors had been concerned with BMJ's seemingly cautious commentary, along with the fact that the trial was taking a long time to read out. Looking ahead, ADEPT-2 data will come in 2026 alongside results from two other ADP studies (one of which is a randomized-withdrawal study, which we view as very likely to succeed). There are still some lingering questions, but overall this is a positive relative to low investor expectations.

Key Points

BMJ continuing ADEPT-2 after identifying some conduct issues--overall this is a positive though there are some lingering questions. Again, there had been concerns here around why BMJ had taken so long to disclose the data when the study completed at the end of July. Now we know that there were certain issues the company was working through, and it's encouraging to see that they engaged the FDA who is seemingly on board with this new plan (and seemingly/hopefully on board with excluding patients from these problematic sites in the primary efficacy analysis). As we see it, muscarinics *should* work in ADP, given their strong efficacy in schizophrenia and considering prior data from LLY with xanomeline in ADP that looked encouraging. For Cobenfy specifically though, our main concern in ADP is TID dosing, tolerability, and navigating a food effect, and with these variables whether enough patients will be able to titrate up to the efficacious dose range. For MPLT, we think there's a chance that their muscarinic has a wider TI in elderly subjects, though for the stock, the Cobenfy ADP readouts next year represent a very significant catalyst--with an upside risk/reward in our view as the current MPLT valuation arguably prices in very little ADP credit.

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Investment Thesis

We rate MPLT shares Buy. MapLight Therapeutics is a clinical-stage biotechnology company focused on developing drugs for neuropsychiatric disorders. Our bullish thesis on MPLT is predicated on the potential of ML-007C-MA, a co-formulated drug consisting of the M1/M4 muscarinic agonist ML-007 and peripheral anticholinergic fesoterodine. MPLT's ongoing ph2 in schizophrenia is de-risked by KarXT's prior success leveraging a similar mechanism, though MPLT is also pursuing a ph2 in Alzheimer's disease psychosis where KarXT clinical data are still upcoming. Despite MPLT entering several years behind KarXT in an already crowded schizophrenia market, the "bar" for success is low and we've seen blockbuster sales for prior antipsychotics with minimal differentiation. In our view, less frequent dosing may be sufficient in itself for prescribers to select ML-007C-MA over KarXT, especially in ADP where KarXT's thrice daily dosing can be cumbersome. Ultimately though, this is CNS and good drugs with strong scientific rationale can still fail in clinical trials, but we think the risk/reward is upside-biased for this stock.

Target Price Methodology/Risks

We derive a \$28 target price for MPLT shares based on our DCF analysis. Our DCF uses an 11% discount rate and 0% terminal growth rate, aligned with other similar stage companies in our coverage universe. In our model we risk-adjust MPLT revenues in SCZ and ADP at 50% and 20%, respectively, which reflects the level of scientific rationale and de-risking clinical data generated to date. We view both the SCZ and ADP as significant commercial opportunities if MPLT is successful. Our terminal growth rate of 0% takes into consideration the longer DCF forecast period extending up to 2038 which may be close to capturing peak sales of ML-007C-MA.

There are many risks to an investment in MapLight Therapeutics, including clinical, regulatory, and commercial risks, as well as the risk of a dilutive equity offering. Specifically, MPLT investors face the risk that ML-007C-MA and other pipeline programs could fail in clinical trials, be impacted by a safety setback, and/or be unable to achieve FDA approval. Beyond clinical trial and regulatory risks, MapLight, like other biotechnology companies, faces significant commercial risks due to competition, pressure from insurers, and/or a variety of other factors. Any of the above variables could impact the stock and our target price significantly.

Company Description

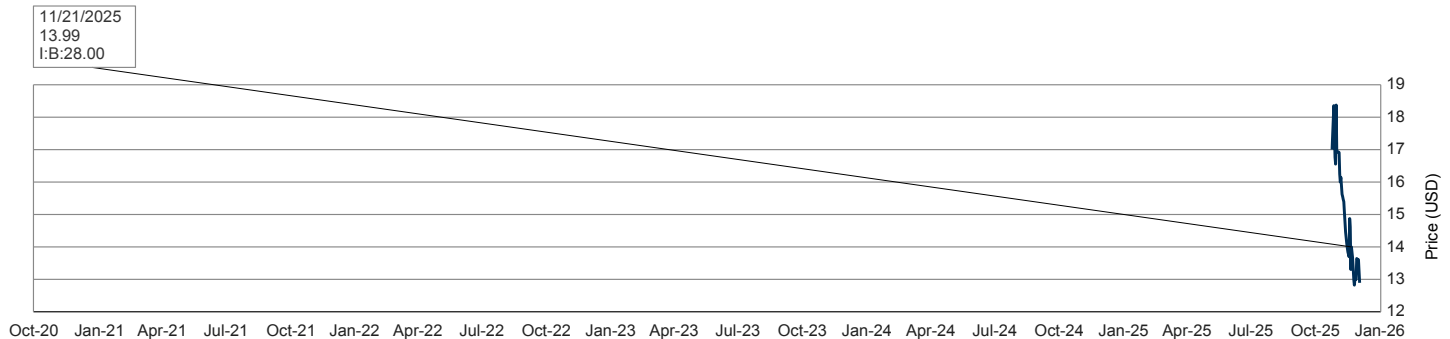
MapLight Therapeutics, Inc is a clinical-stage biopharmaceutical company focused on advancing multiple drug candidates for neuropsychiatric disorders. Their lead candidate, ML-007C-MA, is a combination of a CNS-penetrant procholinergic compound with a peripherally-restricted anticholinergic compound to mitigate side effects, similar to KarXT. ML-007C-MA is currently being evaluated for the treatment of both schizophrenia and Alzheimer's disease psychosis in separate ph2 studies. MapLight also has other drugs in the pipeline including ML-004 for sociability/irritability associated with Autism Spectrum Disorder.

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MapLight Therapeutics, Inc. (MPLT) as of December 02, 2025 (in USD)



*Represents the value(s) that changed.

Buy=B; Hold=H; Sell=S; Discontinued=D; Suspended=SU; Discontinued=D; Initiation=I

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The recommendation contained in this report was produced at 3 December 2025 10:53EST and disseminated at 3 December 2025 10:53EST.

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